

Small words.

Big family stories.

6 rounds / roughly 20 minutes / suggested age 10+ / English edition

WHAT YOU NEED

3-6 people for the guessing game: one reader hosts all six rounds; everyone else plays and scores. For two people, use the cooperative version on page 2. Bring pencils, identical paper slips and a score sheet.

PRINT AND MAKE

Print at 100% / Actual Size, portrait, on the matching paper size. Pages 3-4 are card fronts and backs: print double-sided, flip on the LONG edge, then cut the borders. Test one sheet first. Matching numbers must meet back-to-back. Or print single-sided and glue matching numbered cards together.

KEEP THE SURPRISE

Print one extra copy of page 3 per scoring player so everyone can solve the same puzzle. Keep card backs and page 5 (the answer key) with the host, out of sight. Nobody needs to race.

BEFORE YOU START

Agree on a host, write the player names on paper and make six score columns. Keep the same host for the whole game; the host does not compete. Younger readers can team up with an adult.

A family prototype by lakeside harb, from devildictionary.com. Suggested age and playing time are starting estimates, not playtest results.

THE DEVIL'S DICTIONARY

HOW TO PLAY

Play all six words, in any order. The host keeps the backs secret.

1 / FIND

The host announces the word. Everyone finds it on their own grid: letters run straight in any of eight directions, including backwards. Each player who finds it without a hint earns 1 point. A player can ask for a hint and still join every later step, but earns no finding point this round.

2 / INVENT

Each player secretly writes one funny definition on a slip, with their initials on the reverse. The host copies the printed card definition onto an identical slip, mixes all slips and reads them twice, numbering them aloud. If a player wrote essentially the printed definition, the host asks for a new version before reading.

3 / GUESS

Players secretly write the number they think came from the card. Reveal all votes together. You cannot vote for your own definition. Guess the printed definition: +1 point. Each other player who chose your invented definition: +1 point for you. The host reveals the source of every answer and records the scores.

4 / CHAT AND FINISH

Read the question on the back. Talking earns no points and anyone may pass. After six rounds, the highest total wins; tied players share the win. Laugh at imaginary situations and everyday habits, never embarrass or name a family member as the joke.

TWO-PLAYER / COOPERATIVE MODE

Keep the back hidden. Find the word together, then each invent a definition aloud. Reveal the back only after both have shared. Discuss the question if you wish. No guessing or points: your challenge is to create six new definitions together. This mode also works for larger groups.

Personal use: print for play with family and friends. Do not resell or redistribute the files. Share devildictionary.com instead.

Text created with generative AI; concept and editorial direction by lakeside harb. New playful definitions, not quotations from Ambrose Bierce. Family prototype v1.0.

01 / FIND THE WORD

HOMEWORK

D N C H M I T G X G
Q O X U V B X W F P
L S X T E P K A Y P
O O I Z D C V B O O
Q B I Z C B G A F J
X O T X K B Z V B T
N M V U W Z H R L W
S O Y K D Q Z J X X
A N E R V J V B S H
H O M E W O R K S S

devildictionary.com

02 / FIND THE WORD

SNACK

F R K J U Y H I U O
G C S X F H J J I Z
U O V T H S P T K V
E J H V B N Y P S J
E V Y G T A I C Z W
L P B L N C I B Q I
N I U M G K C D O G
N S G X S Y V F I P
A W M B K O J Z S P
M M Z M B M G E R I

devildictionary.com

03 / FIND THE WORD

BEDTIME

B V Y T F E Z W N R
H P Q D U E J E W F
F B K Q G V P T K Q
U O E Q D E K Q V W
W W W D C E H D L Y
F H J N T B Y Y L B
I W T I J I X X O E
C X C Q B F M D E W
Q D U H D U B E P T
B N L T G G D D Q E

devildictionary.com

04 / FIND THE WORD

SCREEN

R Z B P N E T R F W
Z U C W E W D S T J
N C Z K F Y C W Z S
T V Y J G R B Y I B
U L W B E V G B N V
Q A F E N U D F V S
N L N X V D L G Y U
Q V M X H W K F H S
U L F O H N U U M H
B N P W L C W T G Q

devildictionary.com

05 / FIND THE WORD

CHORES

J E S E R O H C A B
S E S J Y Z B R E K
J V W I I G F J Y E
Q E N K I A Q N G L
E X O Y I L A H K N
N X H J N H F O H A
Y A M K F A P Z D E
K L M K L Z B O R M
B H F I Y U O C J V
K V D V Y M O I L F

devildictionary.com

06 / FIND THE WORD

TOMORROW

E Z V C W N I X C W
J T F W M A V F E Z
J L Y E K T O W H M
Z G Y B U O O R W H
G A C M F R B Z B F
L O Y N R O S Y Y Y
V Z W O Y P J U B L
G L M Y C B X W X U
P O R L I L P I R E
T Q C M W C S Y Y W

devildictionary.com

02 / THE REVEAL

SNACK

A tiny meal with a talent for happening five times.

LET US IMAGINE.

Invent a snack with the most ridiculous name.

devildictionary.com

01 / THE REVEAL

HOMEWORK

Schoolwork that has learned your home address.

LET US IMAGINE.

If homework could do itself, what would you do instead?

devildictionary.com

04 / THE REVEAL

SCREEN

A rectangle that makes five minutes disappear.

LET US IMAGINE.

Invent something fun to do without a screen.

devildictionary.com

03 / THE REVEAL

BEDTIME

The moment everyone suddenly has important questions.

LET US IMAGINE.

What would your pillow say if it could talk?

devildictionary.com

06 / THE REVEAL

TOMORROW

The busiest day in the family calendar.

LET US IMAGINE.

If tomorrow had room for one adventure, what would it be?

devildictionary.com

05 / THE REVEAL

CHORES

Jobs that become invisible when a game begins.

LET US IMAGINE.

Which chore deserves its own superhero?

devildictionary.com

01 / SOLUTION

HOMEWORK

D N C H M I T G X G
 Q O X U V B X W F P
 L S X T E P K A Y P
 O O I Z D C V B O O
 Q B I Z C B G A F J
 X O T X K B Z V B T
 N M V U W Z H R L W
 S O Y K D Q Z J X X
 A N E R V J V B S H
 H O M E W O R K S S

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02 / SOLUTION

SNACK

F R K J U Y H I U O
 G C S X F H J J I Z
 U O V T H S P T K V
 E J H V B N Y P S J
 E V Y G T A I C Z W
 L P B L N C I B Q I
 N I U M G K C D O G
 N S G X S Y V F I P
 A W M B K O J Z S P
 M M Z M B M G E R I

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03 / SOLUTION

BEDTIME

B V Y T F E Z W N R
 H P Q D U E J E W F
 F B K Q G V P T K Q
 U O E Q D E K Q V W
 W W W D C E H D L Y
 F H J N T B Y Y L B
 I W T I J I X X O E
 C X C Q B F M D E W
 Q D U H D U B E P T
 B N L T G G D D Q E

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04 / SOLUTION

SCREEN

R Z B P N E T R F W
 Z U C W E W D S T J
 N C Z K F Y C W Z S
 T V Y J G R B Y I B
 U L W B E V G B N V
 Q A F E N U D F V S
 N L N X V D L G Y U
 Q V M X H W K F H S
 U L F O H N U U M H
 B N P W L C W T G Q

devildictionary.com

05 / SOLUTION

CHORES

J E S E R O H C A B
 S E S J Y Z B R E K
 J V W I I G F J Y E
 Q E N K I A Q N G L
 E X O Y I L A H K N
 N X H J N H F O H A
 Y A M K F A P Z D E
 K L M K L Z B O R M
 B H F I Y U O C J V
 K V D V Y M O I L F

devildictionary.com

06 / SOLUTION

TOMORROW

E Z V C W N I X C W
 J T F W M A V F E Z
 J L Y E K T O W H M
 Z G Y B U O O R W H
 G A C M F R B Z B F
 L O Y N R O S Y Y Y
 V Z W O Y P J U B L
 G L M Y C B X W X U
 P O R L I L P I R E
 T Q C M W C S Y Y W

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